

Job Search

A short guide for Codex and Claude Code

Your AI helps organize the search.
You review the facts and documents.

[Open the GitHub guide](#)

1. Open your AI app

Choose one desktop app and sign in.

Codex

Download the ChatGPT desktop app, then choose Codex inside it.

[Mac download page \(Apple Silicon\)](#)

[Windows download page](#)

Claude Code

Download Claude, then open Code and select Local.

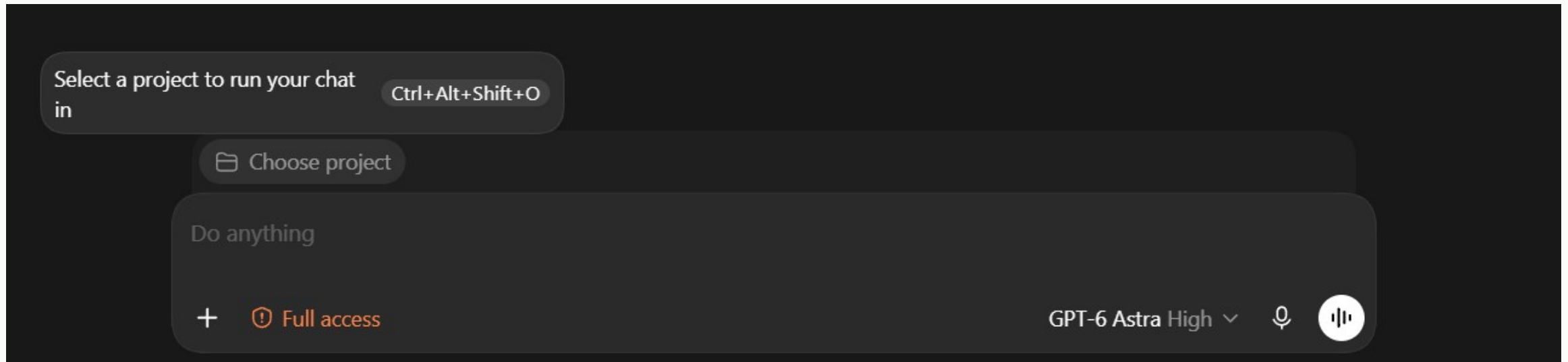
[Mac or Windows downloads](#)

[Claude Code setup and account requirements](#)

Already installed? Continue to your project. Labels and availability can vary by version.

a. Choose your project

In Codex, click Choose project above the message box.



Choose an existing job-search project, or create a new one.
Use a dedicated folder such as My Job Search.

b. Select or create your folder

In Codex Create project:

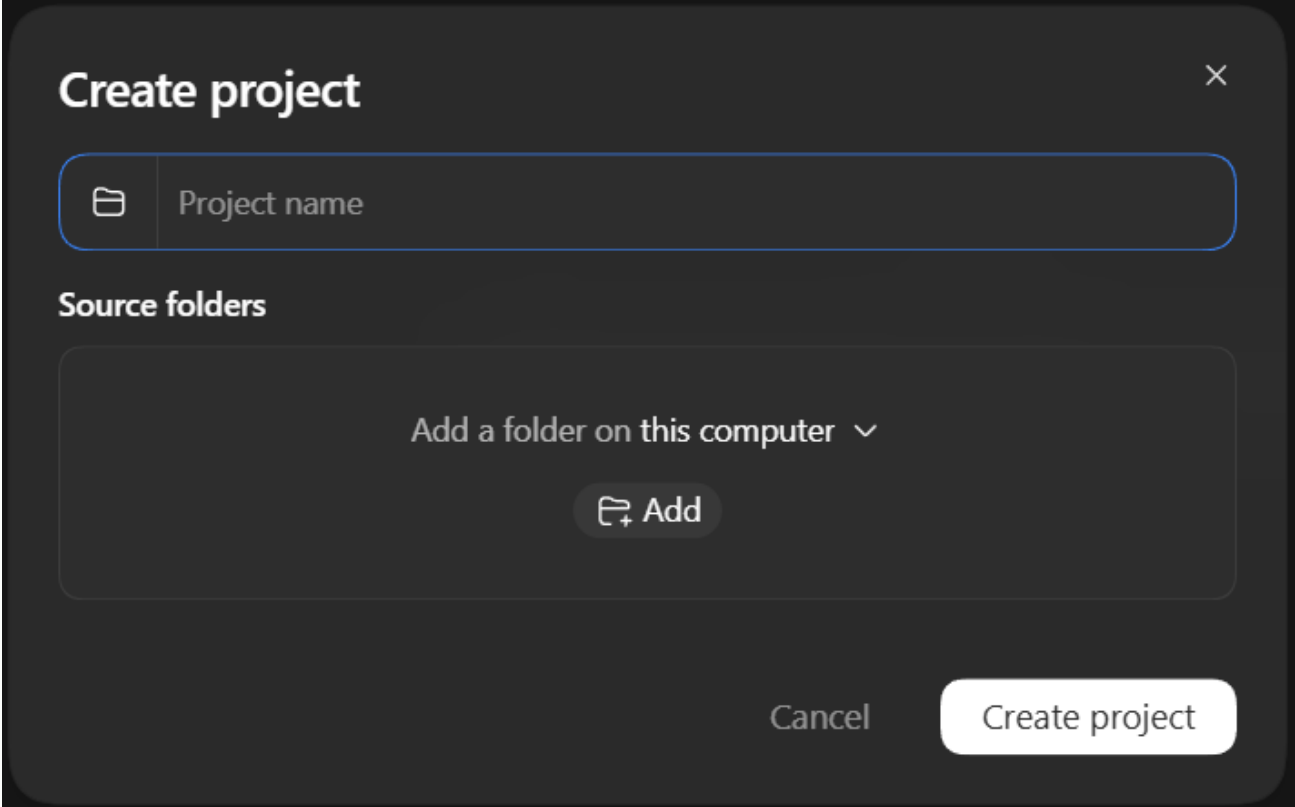
Enter My Job Search.

Under Source folders, click Add.

Select your folder, then click
Create project.

Need a new folder?

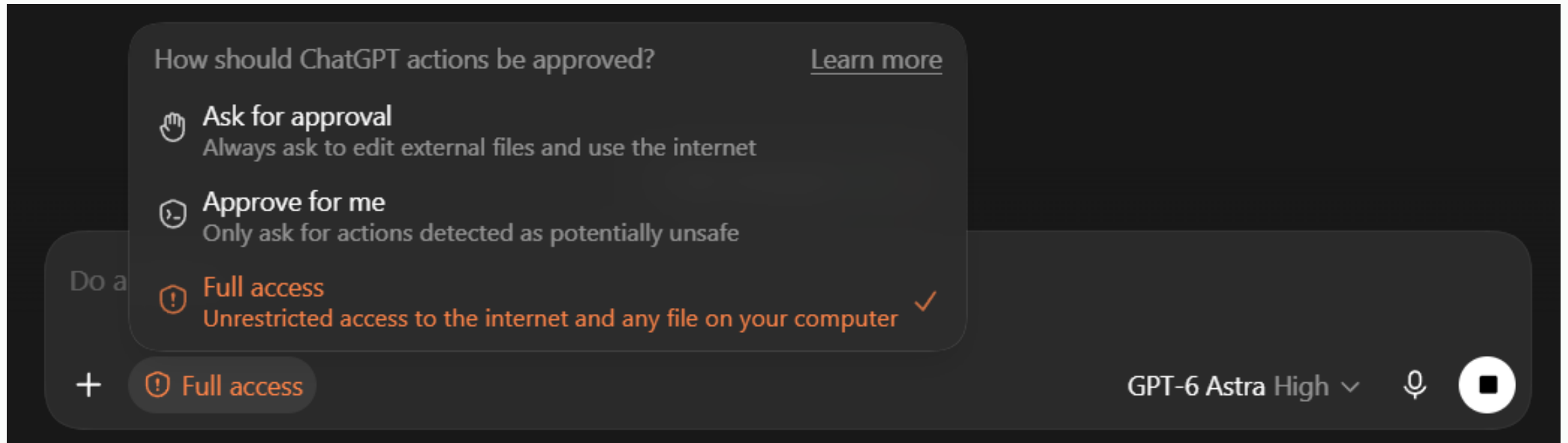
Create it in Documents using
File Explorer or Finder first.

A screenshot of the 'Create project' dialog box in Claude Code. The dialog has a dark background and a title bar with a close button (X). Below the title, there is a text input field for 'Project name' with a folder icon on the left. Underneath, the section 'Source folders' contains a large rectangular area with the text 'Add a folder on this computer' and a dropdown arrow. Below this area is a button with a folder icon and the text 'Add'. At the bottom right of the dialog are two buttons: 'Cancel' and 'Create project'.

Claude Code: Local, then Select folder.

c. Codex: Full access

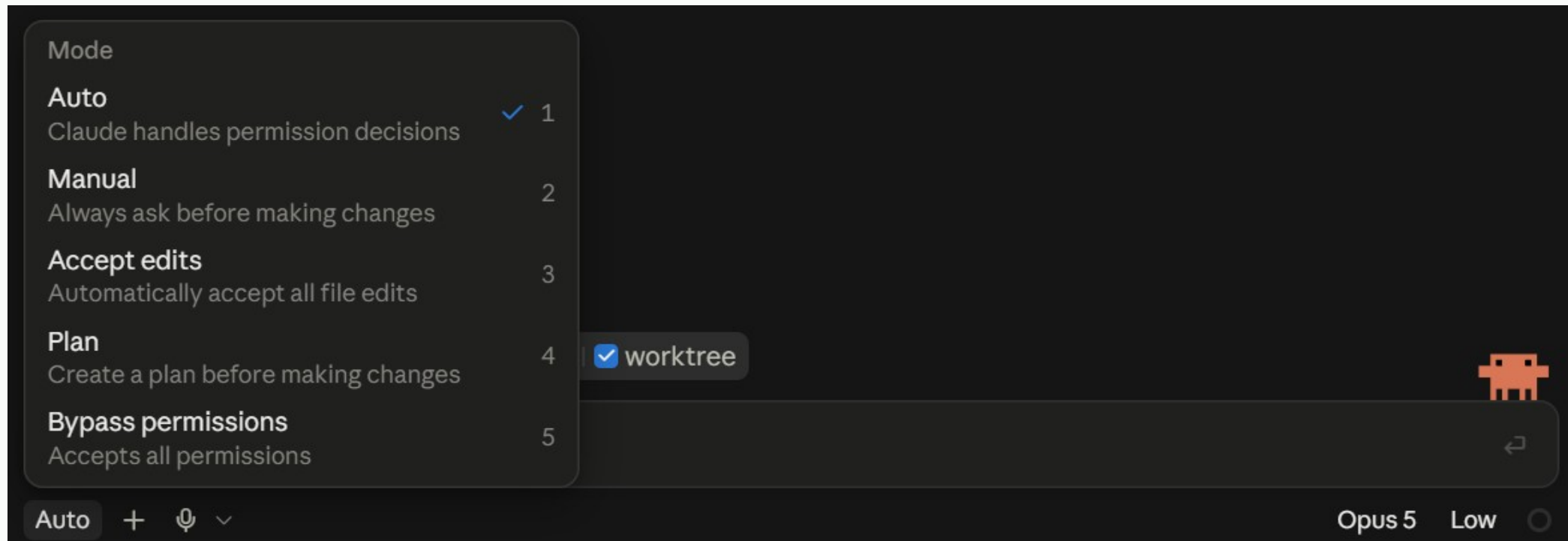
Click the permission label below your message.
Select Full access, as shown.



Full access allows internet and file access across your computer, including files outside the selected project.

d. Claude Code: Auto

Click the mode label below your message. Select Auto.



Claude handles permission decisions with background safety checks.
Some actions can still require your input.

2. Your resume

If you have one

Attach your PDF or Word file before sending the first message.
If attachments are unavailable, paste its full file location.

If you do not have one

Add: “I do not have a resume yet. Help me build one.”

Add your LinkedIn URL too. The AI can reconcile profile details with your records.

3. Your first message

Copy both lines into the same message box as your resume:

**Install <https://github.com/toughdave/job-search> for this project.
Then use job-search to start my search.**

Add your resume location or no-resume sentence if needed.
Press Send once. Follow any installation approval or restart request.

[Copy from the README](#)

Software prerequisites

Use a local project with file access and an internet connection.
Your AI app needs an account that can use local projects.

The AI checks Python 3.9+ and installs the document packages.
Node.js 22.20+ is only needed for the optional terminal installer.

Your records stay in the project. Software stays in a local cache.
Ask the AI to preview that cache if you want to remove it.

Word uploads also need a DOCX renderer, such as Word or LibreOffice.

4. A short conversation

The AI saves each question, asks it, and waits for your answer.

Example: Cedar Clinic, Office Assistant, 2022-2024

“At Cedar Clinic, tell me about one scheduling problem you handled as an office assistant.”

Explain what you did and what happened at that employer.
Your saved answers help the AI ask only for missing details.

LinkedIn review follows the fuller interview. Public edits need your approval.

Optional inbox connection

- a. Confirm the email you use for applications.
Choose whether the AI may check job-related replies.
- b. When prompted, connect Gmail in your AI app.
Sign in to the Google account you chose.
- c. The AI checks the connected address and read access.
It waits if the account is wrong or unavailable.

You can choose no or later and still prepare resumes and find jobs.
Sending email and changing your calendar need separate permission.

[Detailed connection steps](#)

Your weekday morning search

- a. Review the job titles and search sites the AI suggests.
- b. Choose a schedule. The starting suggestion is weekdays at 9 a.m. in your confirmed timezone.
- c. Let the AI save the instructions and set up the task.
You can change the time or keep searches manual.

Keep your computer awake and the desktop app running for local searches.

Review and change your routine

Codex desktop: Scheduled

Claude Code Desktop: Code → Routines

The AI checks unfinished applications and new listings, then prepares suitable drafts for your review.

“Move my daily search to 8 a.m.”

“Pause my scheduled search.”

[Read the daily-search guide](#)

Your resume length and format

After reviewing your experience, the AI recommends a length for your target work and destination.

“May I use a two-page resume as your standard?”

Approve the recommendation or ask for a different length.
Fewer relevant roles may fit one page. A longer CV needs a reason.

The AI checks regional guidance and reviews each page for readable, useful spacing.

5. Your first draft

Before any upload, the AI visually inspects every page of the actual file. It checks spacing, alignment, clipping and page breaks.

A Word upload needs a preview rendered from that exact DOCX. If visual review is unavailable, the file stays a draft and upload waits.

“That role was volunteering. Please correct it.”

After corrections, the AI checks the new file again. You approve final submission.

Summon the installed skill

Codex / ChatGPT desktop

Type @ and choose job-search. If your composer offers a \$ skill picker, choose job-search there.

Codex CLI or IDE: \$job-search

Claude Code: /job-search

Add “Start my search” or “Continue my job search”, then send. Use the AI message box after installation, in the same project.

If the skill is missing, start a new session in this project, then try again.

6. Next time

- a. Reopen the same local project. A new conversation is fine.
- b. Summon job-search, then send:

Continue my job search.

- c. The AI checks its tools and reads your saved progress.
Supply an updated resume when it changes.

For an independent occupation search, use a new project with separate records.

If something stops you

Skill missing?

Start a new session in the same project.
Say: “Check installation and load job-search for me.”

Cannot save?

Check the selected folder and file permissions. Approve the specific access request if you want it to proceed.

Moved the folder or cannot find your records?

Choose the new project folder and give the AI your records location.
Say: “Reconnect my existing search here and continue.”

[Full guide, downloads and troubleshooting](#)